

It's Easy to Build an App with Ember.JS!



This article presents a tutorial on how to build a simple app using the Ember.JS framework.

EMBER.js is a popular, free and open source JavaScript Web framework, based on the model-view-view-model (MVVM) pattern. Although Ember.js is primarily considered a framework for the Web, it can also be used to build mobile and desktop applications. With over 17,000 stars and over 3400 forks at the time of writing this article, it is a very popular framework on GitHub. Moreover, it has some great features, which we will explore further in this article.

Ember.js is one of the front-end stack components built by the Ember core team. Here are some great features of the EmberJS framework.

Ember CLI

The Ember CLI (command line interface) allows the user to generate a new Ember app with the default stack.

This utility provides:

- A standard directory and file structure.
- A server with live reload, which means it will automatically rebuild and reload apps whenever the files are changed.
- Support for ES6 modules.
- ES6/ES7 syntax support via Babel.
- Ember CLI testing framework.
- Dependencies managed via npm and Bower.
- Blueprints, which is a code generator for creating models and controller — components that are needed in an app.
- More features are available when using Ember CLI addons, of which there are over 2,000 available.

Ember Data

- Ember Data is a data-persistence library providing facilities for an object relational mapping to the Ember app.

Ember Inspector

This is a Web browser extension, available for Mozilla Firefox and Google Chrome. It makes debugging Ember applications easier, enabling users to watch template changes (in which views and components are currently rendered), and see the properties of Ember objects along with a UI, which also allows users to access the app's objects in the console itself.

Fastboot

Fastboot is an Ember CLI extension, which allows users to run their Ember apps in Node.js. Currently, this is in the alpha stage — once available, this feature will allow users to render the UI much faster.

Liquid Fire

Liquid Fire is a toolkit which allows animated transitions in an Ember app.

 **Note:** It is assumed that you have some basic knowledge of Web technologies like HTML, CSS and JavaScript. If you don't, W3Schools (<http://www.w3schools.com/>) is a good place to start. The site has some great tutorials for Web technologies that are easy to follow.

Before we start developing our sample app, let us have a look at the core concepts of the EmberJS framework, which are shown in Figure 1.

Route and route handlers

In Ember, the state of an app is represented by a URL. When the Ember app starts, the router is responsible for displaying templates, loading data or setting up the application state. It